HACK MATRIX HACKATHON

TITLE PAGE

- **PROJECT TITLE :** RAAHI-Routes to Authentic & Amazing Hidden India (HM40 Hidden Gems Local Guide)
- **TEAM NAME :** HackHers
- **TEAM MEMBERS :** Avani
  Suhani Boxi
  Lipsa Rani Panda

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Who is Affected?

- **Travelers** who want to explore beyond typical tourist spots often struggle to find authentic, lesser-known places
- **Local explorers** miss out on discovering hidden gems within their own cities due to lack of structured information
- **Small businesses and local vendors** (street food stalls, markets, local cafes) remain unnoticed and under-promoted
- **Local guides and students** lack a proper platform to showcase their knowledge and earn through guiding

Most existing travel platforms primarily highlight popular and commercialized destinations, driven by ratings and trends. This results in hidden gems being overlooked, even though they offer more authentic and unique experiences. There is no structured platform where locals can easily share such places, and travelers can discover them in an organized, map-based manner.

Why is this Problem Important?

- **Loss of Authentic Experience:** Travelers miss real local culture and discover only mainstream spots
- **Economic Imbalance:** Revenue is concentrated in popular destinations, ignoring local businesses
- **Overtourism:** Famous places become overcrowded, reducing travel quality and sustainability
- **Untapped Potential:** Countless hidden gems across India remain unexplored

EXISTING SOLUTIONS AND GAPS

Existing Solutions

Popular Travel Apps

- Google Maps, TripAdvisor, MakeMyTrip
- Show top-rated and popular tourist spots
- Focus on reviews, ratings, and navigation

Map-Based Platforms

- Provide location-based discovery and directions
- Show nearby places like restaurants, cafes, landmarks

Travel Guide Services

- Offer guided tours and packages
- Mostly include professional or agency-based guides

Social Media / Blogs

- Instagram, YouTube, travel blogs
- Share travel experiences and hidden places

Limitations of Existing Solutions

Focus mainly on crowded tourist destinations

Hidden gems are rarely discovered or highlighted

Lack of local, authentic insights

No structured platform for local contributions

Limited personalization (same suggestions for everyone)

No proper system for finding local guides or travel buddies

Social content is unorganized and not map-based

How RAAHI Fills the Gap

- Promotes hidden gems submitted by locals (core focus)
- Provides interactive map with custom pins for easy discovery
- Combines community + travel (buddies, reviews, connections)
- Offers verified local guides for authentic experiences
- Uses AI (Gem Genie) for personalized recommendations
- Creates a structured platform for stories, photos, and insights
- Supports local economy by promoting small businesses

PROPOSED SOLUTION

OUR SOLUTION

RAAHI is built on the idea that the true essence of a city lies in the places only locals know. While most travel apps highlight crowded tourist spots, RAAHI shifts the focus to hidden gems shared by real people: from quiet cafés to unexplored streets and cultural corners. These places are mapped visually and enriched with stories, making discovery more meaningful. By combining local contributions, trusted guides, and personalized recommendations, RAAHI transforms travel into a more authentic, human, and immersive experience.

List key features

Tourist Portal

- User login & profile (history, reviews, badges, points)
- Discover hidden gems via map + city search
- Filter by interests (food, culture, shopping, etc.)
- Personalized recommendations based on time & purpose
- Hire verified local guides (rating, gender, safety)
- Create custom itineraries (hours/days)
- Community:
  - Connect with travelers
  - Find travel buddies
  - Share reviews & experiences

Guide / Local Portal

- Register & get verified
- Create profile (expertise, areas, itineraries)
- Submit hidden gems (photos + description + map)
- Receive booking requests from tourists
- Earn via bookings (partial advance payment)
- Gain ratings, reviews & badges

Content & Trust

- Hidden gems submitted by locals (core feature)
- Each gem includes photos, story & location
- Influencer/verified reviews for credibility
- Top-rated gems highlighted on homepage
- Ratings & reviews ensure trust and quality

Explain how it solves the problem

Focuses on hidden, lesser-known places instead of tourist hotspots

Uses local contributions to surface authentic experiences

Provides interactive map-based discovery (easy and visual)

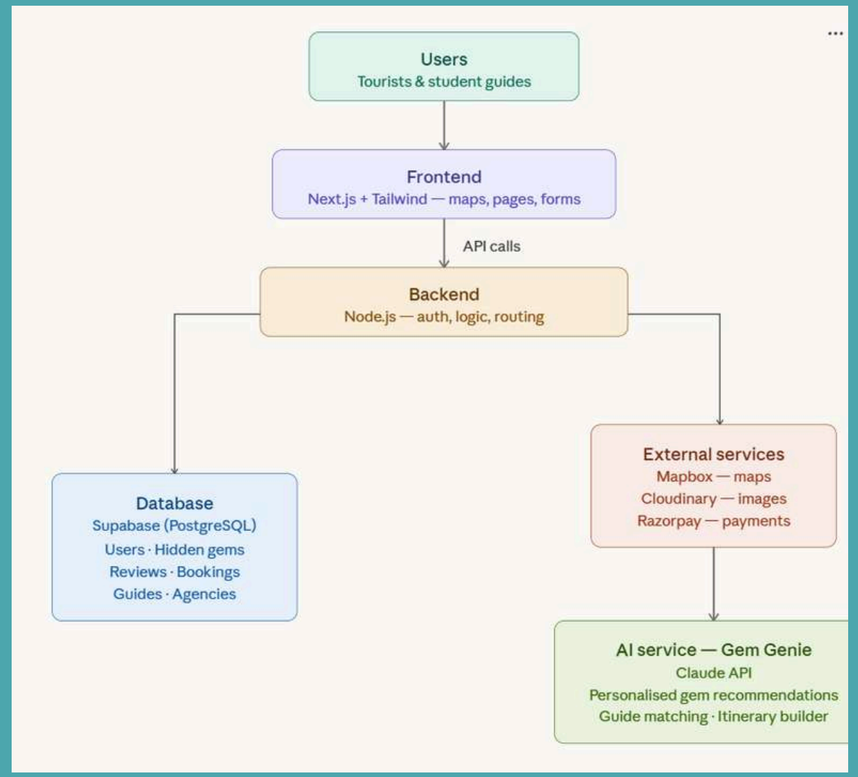
Builds trust through reviews, badges, and verification

Enables personalized travel via guides and itineraries

Adds community + human connection, missing in other apps

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

Architecture diagram



Frontend technologies

- Built using Next.js + Tailwind CSS
- Handles user interface (map, pages, forms)
- Enables actions like exploring gems, booking guides, submissions
- Communicates with bacakend via API calls

Backend technologies

- Acts as the core logic layer
- Handles authentication, requests, and business logic
- Processes gem submissions, bookings, reviews, and AI queries
- Connects frontend with database and external services

Database

- Uses Supabase (PostgreSQL)
- Stores users, hidden gems, reviews, and bookings
- Ensures secure storage and fast data retrieval
- Supports real-time updates

Tools and APIs

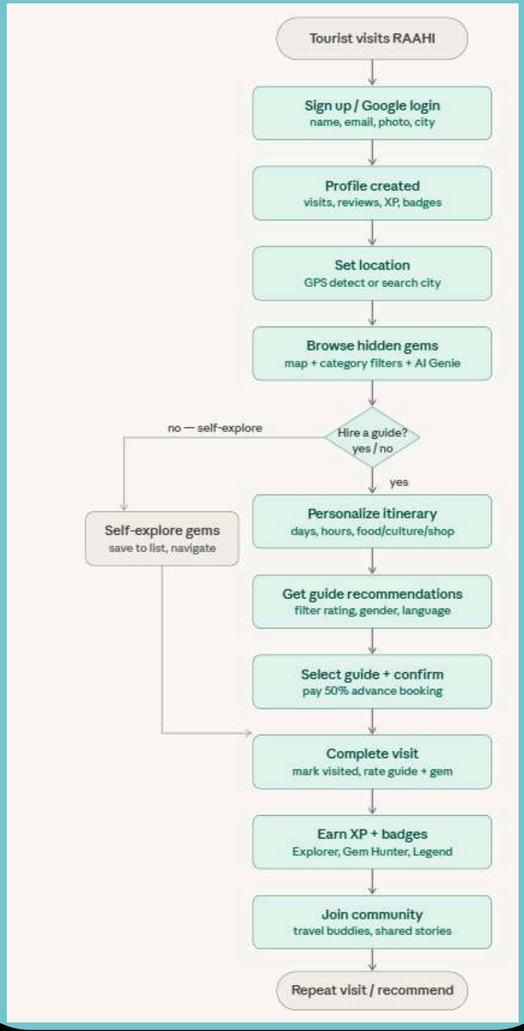
- APIs & Integrations
- Mapbox → Interactive maps & custom pins
- Cloudinary → Image upload & storage
- Razorpay → Payment processing
- Claude API → AI recommendations (Gem Genie)
-

Data Flow

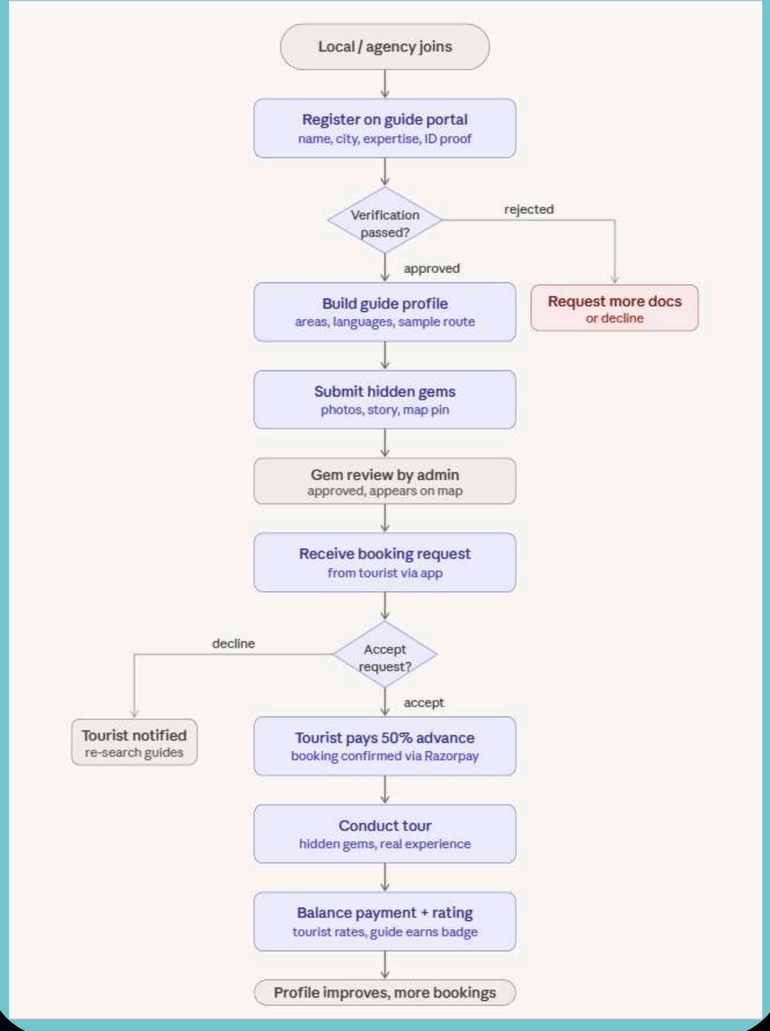
- User interacts with the app (search, explore map, submit gem, or book guide) through the frontend
- Frontend sends API requests to the backend with user inputs (location, filters, preferences)
- Backend processes the request and retrieves/stores data from the database
- Relevant data (gems, guides, reviews) is sent back to the frontend
- Frontend displays results as map pins, lists, and detail views

FLOWCHART / WORKING PROCESS

USER (TOURIST) FLOWCHART



GUIDE PORTAL FLOWCHART



Show step-by-step working

- User signs up and creates a personalized travel profile with preferences, history, and badges
- Sets current location or searches a city to explore
- Discovers hidden gems on an interactive map with filters (food, culture, markets, etc.)
- Uses filters or AI (Gem Genie) to get personalized recommendations based on interests
- Views detailed information of each place (photos, story, ratings, reviews)
- Connects with like-minded travelers and finds travel buddies for shared experiences
- Browses and selects verified local guides based on ratings, language, and safety preferences
- Sends booking request and confirms with secure partial payment
- Experiences the trip with local guides and community interaction
- Shares reviews, earns points, badges, and contributes to the platform
- Can submit new hidden gems, helping the platform grow continuously

TECH STACK

Core Framework & Language

Next.js: Used to build a fast, scalable, and SEO-friendly frontend for RAAHI. It enables smooth navigation, dynamic pages, and efficient rendering for maps and user interfaces.

TypeScript: Ensures type safety and improves code reliability, making the application more maintainable and scalable.

Tailwind CSS: A utility-first CSS framework used to create a clean, responsive, and modern UI quickly.

Intelligence Layer (AI & Personalization)

Gem Genie (Claude API): Powers AI-based recommendations by analyzing user queries and suggesting hidden gems based on preferences and context.

Recommendation Logic: Processes user behavior, filters, and interests to provide personalized travel suggestions.

Map & Location Services

Mapbox API: Enables interactive maps with custom pins to visualize hidden gems and improve location-based discovery.

Geolocation API: Detects user location to provide nearby recommendations and enhance real-time exploration.

Database & Storage

Supabase (PostgreSQL): Stores user data, hidden gems, reviews, and bookings with built-in authentication and real-time capabilities.

Cloudinary: Manages image uploads and optimization for fast and efficient media delivery.

Community & Engagement Layer

User Profiles & Gamification: Tracks user activity, reviews, badges, and points to increase engagement.

Community Interaction System: Enables travel buddy matching, connections, and shared experiences.

System Logic & Backend

Backend (Next.js API / Node.js): Handles authentication, business logic, gem submissions, bookings, and data processing.

REST APIs: Facilitate communication between frontend, backend, and external services.

IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Step-by-step development plan

Step 1: Planning & Design

- Finalize features based on problem statement
- Design UI/UX (map, gem cards, profiles, forms)
- Define database structure (users, gems, reviews, bookings)

Step 2: Frontend Development

- Build UI using Next.js + Tailwind
- Create main pages:
- Homepage
- Map Explorer
- Gem Detail Page
- Submit Gem Form
- Implement navigation and responsive design

Step 3: Backend Development

- Set up API routes / server logic
- Implement:
- Authentication (login/signup)
- Gem submission & retrieval
- Guide booking system
- Reviews & ratings

Step 4: Database Integration

- Set up Supabase (PostgreSQL)
- Create tables:
- Users
- Gems
- Reviews
- Bookings
- Connect backend with database

Step 5: API Integrations

- Integrate Mapbox for map & pins
- Use Cloudinary for image uploads
- Add Razorpay for payments
- Connect Claude API for AI (Gem Genie)

Step 6: Core Feature Implementation

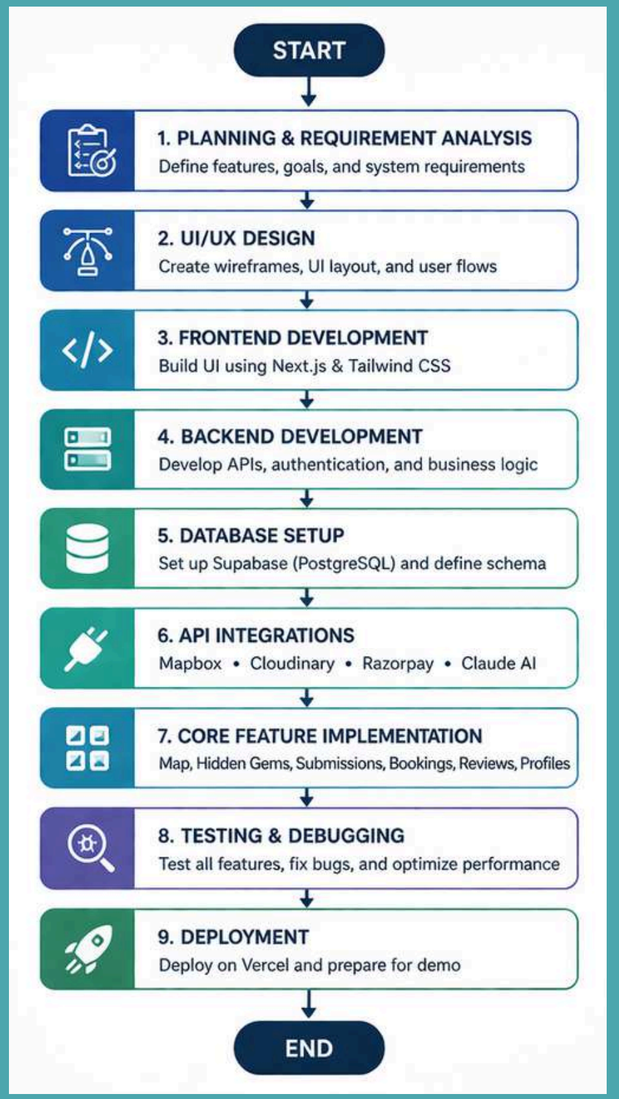
- Interactive map with filters
- Hidden gem submission system
- Guide listing & booking
- User profiles & badges

Step 7: Testing & Optimization

- Test all flows (search, booking, submission)
- Fix bugs and improve performance
- Ensure smooth UI/UX

Step 8: Deployment

- Deploy frontend/backend on Vercel
- Final testing and demo preparation



Modules or features to be built

User Module

- Login / Signup
- Profile (badges, travel history)
- Preferences (location, interests)

Hidden Gem Module

- Submit hidden gems
- Upload photos + description
- View gem details

Map Module

- Interactive map
- Custom pins
- Nearby recommendations

Community Module

- Reviews & ratings
- Travel buddy finder
- User interaction

Guide Module

- Guide registration & verification
- Booking requests
- Payment system

Rating & Trust Module

- Reviews for gems & guides
- Top-rated section
- Influencer validation

EXPECTED OUTCOME / IMPACT

Expected results of the project

- Development of a fully functional PAN-India platform focused on discovering hidden gems through local contributions
- An interactive map-based system with custom pins, filters, and detailed place pages for seamless exploration
- A user-generated content ecosystem where locals submit authentic places with photos, stories, and reviews
- Integration of AI-powered recommendations (Gem Genie) to provide personalized suggestions based on user preferences
- A combined system of tourist and guide portals, enabling both discovery and guided experiences

Benefits to users

- Enables users to explore authentic, non-touristy locations that are usually missed by traditional travel apps
- Provides personalized travel planning through filters, AI suggestions, and customizable itineraries
- Ensures safety and trust through verified local guides, ratings, and review systems
- Enhances travel experiences by allowing users to:
- Connect with like-minded travelers
- Find travel companions
- Share experiences and feedback
- Saves time and effort by offering all-in-one discovery, planning, and booking within a single platform

Real-world impact

- Promotes local economies by increasing visibility of small businesses such as food stalls, markets, and local attractions
- Encourages sustainable tourism by reducing overcrowding at popular tourist destinations
- Creates income opportunities for locals through guide services and content contributions
- Builds a community-driven travel ecosystem where users actively contribute and benefit
- Transforms travel behavior by shifting focus from mainstream tourism to authentic local exploration

FUTURE SCOPE AND CONCLUSION

Scalability of the Project

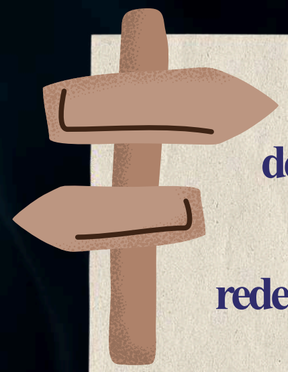
- Pan-India to Global Expansion

Start with India, scale to international cities with local contributors

- Community-Driven Growth Model
- More users → more submissions → richer discovery ecosystem
- Partnership Opportunities
- Collaboration with tourism boards, local businesses, and travel agencies
- Flexible Monetization
- Guide bookings, premium listings, and featured experiences

Future Improvements

- AI-Powered Recommendations
- Smarter suggestions based on behavior, preferences, and travel patterns
- AR-Based Exploration
- Real-time directions and hidden stories through augmented reality
- Multilingual & Voice Support
- Making the platform accessible across diverse regions of India
- Influencer & Creator Integration
- Verified content from travel creators to boost trust and discovery



"From crowded destinations to hidden stories — RAAHI redefines the way the world travels."

RAAHI is not just a travel app — it is a community-powered discovery platform that transforms how people explore places. By connecting local knowledge with traveler curiosity, it unlocks experiences that traditional platforms overlook.